

Innovation and Startup Seed Fund Scheme — Scheme Guidelines

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Issued in 2025 by Higher Education Department under reference HEIRS/SCH/2025/024, this scheme guidelines establishes the arrangements supporting Innovation and Startup Seed Fund Scheme. In scope are Innovation, Startup, Seed Fund, together with related expectations for institutions and stakeholders.

Context and Background

Following sustained engagement with universities, colleges and sector bodies, Higher Education Department has prepared this scheme guidelines to give effect to Innovation, Startup. It builds on earlier guidance while updating expectations to reflect current conditions.

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Purpose

The purpose of this document is to establish a consistent basis for Innovation, Startup across Higher Education Department-affiliated institutions, to clarify responsibilities, and to define the outcomes expected of every stakeholder.

By setting out the rationale, scope and operating expectations for Innovation, the document aims to reduce ambiguity, support institutional planning and improve the quality of Startup across the system.

Policy Objectives

In pursuing these objectives, Higher Education Department intends to create conditions in which institutions can deliver consistent, high-quality outcomes in respect of Innovation, Startup, Seed Fund, with clear lines of accountability.

The principal objectives are to strengthen Innovation, harmonise institutional approaches to Startup, and establish measurable indicators through which progress can be tracked and reported.

Scope

This document covers all activities and stakeholders associated with Innovation within institutions affiliated to Higher Education Department, together with arrangements for monitoring, review and reporting of outcomes.

Applicable across the full range of institutions governed by Higher Education Department, the document addresses planning, delivery, resourcing and evaluation, and may be supplemented by operational guidance issued subsequently.

Core Provisions

Key provisions establish minimum standards for Innovation, define the responsibilities of institutional leadership, and require documented arrangements for Startup.

The document mandates periodic self-assessment against Innovation, disclosure of material information to Higher Education Department, and corrective action where institutional performance falls short of the stated expectations.

Implementation Framework

Implementation will proceed through phased institutional adoption, supported by professional development, shared guidance and a common reporting calendar established by Higher Education Department.

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Institutional Responsibilities

Heads of institutions bear overall responsibility for embedding Innovation, supported by designated coordinators, academic bodies and administrative units within each institution.

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Performance Monitoring

Progress will be monitored through annual institutional returns, targeted reviews and outcome indicators maintained centrally by Higher Education Department. Findings will inform guidance and, where necessary, corrective measures.

Conclusion

The success of this scheme rests on shared understanding and consistent application. Higher Education Department stands ready to support institutions in implementing Innovation and looks forward to reviewing collective progress.